SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

5 September 2023 · Shift 1

45 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 45 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

What does the term ‘interest’ refer to in banking?

(A) The additional amount earned on a loan or deposit
(B) The amount of money deposited into a bank account
(C) The value of a currency in relation to other currencies
(D) The fee charged for withdrawing money from an ATM

Q.2

Bihu is a folk dance of which state?

(A) Bihar
(B) Assam
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.3

In which year did Lord Curzon announce the partition of Bengal during the British rule in India?

(A) 1904
(B) 1906
(C) 1905
(D) 1907

Q.4

Which of the following statements are correct regarding the Power Sector’s Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme? 1) The Prime Minister launched the Ministry of Power’s flagship Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme in 2022. 2) This scheme is aimed at improving the operational efficiencies and financial sustainability of distribution companies. 3) From FY 2022-23 to FY 2027-28, the scheme aims to provide financial assistance to DISCOMs. 4)This scheme proposes to provide 25 crore Smart Prepaid meters to consumers all over the country.

(A) 1, 3 and 4
(B) 1, 2 and 4
(C) 2, 3 and 4
(D) 1, 2 and 3

Q.5

‘Mein Kampf’ is the autobiography of which world personality?

(A) Adolf Hitler
(B) Robert Mugabe
(C) Albert Einstein
(D) Charlie Chaplin

Q.6

What is the geographic location of the world's largest coral reef, known as the Great Barrier Reef?

(A) Switzerland
(B) Australia
(C) China
(D) Ireland

Q.8

Popular since ancient eras for the trading of livestock, _____, which is a month-long event, takes place on the auspicious occasion of Kartik Purnima in the month of November near Harihar Nath temple.

(A) Sonepur Mela
(B) Rajgir Mela
(C) Pushkar Mela
(D) Ardhkumbh Mela

Q.9

How many states were selected in Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan (GKRA) 2020?

(A) 16 states
(B) 6 states
(C) 10 states
(D) 8 states

Q.12

Which of the following is NOT a part of the six communication mail channels in India?

(A) Metro channel
(B) Monthly channel
(C) Rajdhani channel
(D) Business channel

Q.13

Which of the following is an example of a non-debt capital receipt in the government budget?

(A) Sale of government-owned land
(B) Loans from international financial institutions
(C) Interest payment on government bonds
(D) Tax revenue collected from citizens

Q.14

Visva Bharati a famous educational institute was founded in 1921 by:

(A) Rabindranath Tagore
(B) Vinoba Bhave
(C) Mother Teresa
(D) Swami Chinmayananda

Q.15

How many women boxers from India won gold medals in the Women's World Boxing Championship 2023?

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 1
(D) 4

Q.16

Famous Bollywood actress Hema Malini is a trained _____ dancer.

(A) Kathak
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Odissi
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.17

Whose prior recommendation is required to introduce money bills in state legislature?

(A) Speaker of the House
(B) Chief Minster
(C) Governor
(D) Advocate General

Q.18

RK Narayan is the author of _____.

(A) The Guide
(B) Far From the Madding Crowd
(C) Godan
(D) Untouchable

Q.19

Where is the Qutub Minar situated?

(A) Delhi
(B) Agra
(C) Lucknow
(D) Chandigarh

Q.20

Which is the most obvious symptom of infantile jaundice that usually appears between the second and fourth day after birth?

(A) Cracking and irritation at the corners of mouth

(B) Swollen or puffy ankles

(C) Yellowing of the skin and the whites of the eyes

(D) Swelling and bleeding of the gums

Q.21

The Units of Linear momentum are measured in _____.

(A) kg^2 m/s

(B) kg m/s^2

(C) k^2g m/s

(D) kg m/s

Q.22

In which of the following cities the 2023 SAFF Championship was held?

(A) Mumbai

(B) Bengaluru

(C) Kochi

(D) Ahmedabad

Q.23

Mirabai Chanu was selected as BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year 2022. She is related to which sport?

(A) Discus throw

(B) Javelin throw

(C) Boxing

(D) Weightlifting

Q.24

Punjab state is rich in which natural resource from the following?

(A) Coal

(B) Petroleum

(C) Silicon

(D) Fertile soil

Q.25

How many schedules are there in our Constitution as of June 2023?

(A) 8

(B) 9

(C) 12

(D) 10

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Diminish

(A) Demote

(B) Relegate

(C) Prevent

(D) Weaken

Q.3

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) We are living / (B) here since / (C) the summer / (D) of last year.

(A) A

(B) C

(C) B

(D) D

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Suresh has been learning Tamil _____ two months.

(A) from

(B) since

(C) before

(D) for

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Rina's house is at "a stone's throw" from the school.

(A) A very long distance
(B) Next to
(C) A very short distance
(D) Not very close to

Q.6

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Wrestler
(B) Accompanyment
(C) Debatable
(D) Discrepancy

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Mohan unknowingly "altered salt instead of sugar" to the dessert making it taste terrible.

(A) added salt instead of sugar
(B) anguished salt instead of sugar
(C) amplified salt instead of sugar
(D) abridged salt instead of sugar

Q.8

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The actor decided to live life "in the fast lane".

(A) Dropping charges of crime
(B) A life filled with excitement
(C) Racing away to the moon
(D) A life of extreme speed

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Sanjana rubbed her eyes hardly.

(A) Sanjana
(B) rubbed
(C) hardly
(D) her eyes

Q.10

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. I asked my friend to _____ against her employers who are doing wrong to her.

(A) fine words butter no parsnips
(B) finders keepers, losers weepers
(C) fight the good fight
(D) fight fire with fire

Q.11

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a misspelt word. The single most important factor that "distinguishes" those of us who "succed" in any "venture" and those of us who don't is this 'instant coffee' "attitude."

(A) venture
(B) attitude
(C) distinguishes
(D) succed

Q.12

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. A night alone / in a hotel / can be lonely prospect.

(A) can be lonely prospect
(B) A night alone
(C) No error
(D) in a hotel

Q.13

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. The “new restaurant” “on Main Street” “is cheap than” “the old one.”

(A) the older one
(B) in Main Street
(C) newer restaurant
(D) is cheaper than

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. “My” relatives “shall” have “reached” Amritsar “by now.”

(A) My
(B) by now
(C) shall
(D) reached

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Group of bees

(A) Gaggle
(B) Shoal
(C) Swarm
(D) Pack

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Crude

(A) Patient
(B) Refined
(C) Primitive
(D) Observant

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Can you quote any _____ in your favour?

(A) answer
(B) summary
(C) lines
(D) precedent

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. Buying a new car can “cost an arm and a leg”.

(A) Be free
(B) Be affordable
(C) Be reasonable
(D) Be expensive

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Insist

(A) Persist
(B) Resist
(C) Heist
(D) Assist

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There are several reasons why people might 1)_____ that homework is an unnecessary burden on children. Firstly, there is evidence to support the idea that homework 2)_____nothing to improve educational outcomes. Countries such as Finland, where school children are not given homework, regularly top international educational league tables and outperform nations where setting homework is the norm. Secondly, many parents would agree that the school day is already 3)_____, and leaves their children too tired to do further study when they return home. 4)_____, it is recognised that play time is just as 5)_____as study time from the perspective of brain development.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 1.

(A) be argues
(B) have argue
(C) argues
(D) argue

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There are several reasons why people might 1)_____ that homework is an unnecessary burden on children. Firstly, there is evidence to support the idea that homework 2)_____nothing to improve educational outcomes. Countries such as Finland, where school children are not given homework, regularly top international educational league tables and outperform nations where setting homework is the norm. Secondly, many parents would agree that the school day is already 3)_____, and leaves their children too tired to do further study when they return home. 4)_____, it is recognised that play time is just as 5)_____as study time from the perspective of brain development.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 2.

(A) will does
(B) has do
(C) does
(D) do

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There are several reasons why people might 1)_____ that homework is an unnecessary burden on children. Firstly, there is evidence to support the idea that homework 2)_____nothing to improve educational outcomes. Countries such as Finland, where school children are not given homework, regularly top international educational league tables and outperform nations where setting homework is the norm. Secondly, many parents would agree that the school day is already 3)_____, and leaves their children too tired to do further study when they return home. 4)_____, it is recognised that play time is just as 5)_____as study time from the perspective of brain development.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 3.

(A) long enough
(B) big enough
(C) not enough
(D) enough of

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There are several reasons why people might 1)_____ that homework is an unnecessary burden on children. Firstly, there is evidence to support the idea that homework 2)_____nothing to improve educational outcomes. Countries such as Finland, where school children are not given homework, regularly top international educational league tables and outperform nations where setting homework is the norm. Secondly, many parents would agree that the school day is already 3)_____, and leaves their children too tired to do further study when they return home. 4)_____, it is recognised that play time is just as 5)_____as study time from the perspective of brain development.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 4.

(A) Similarly
(B) Normally
(C) Finally
(D) Usually

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There are several reasons why people might 1)_____ that homework is an unnecessary burden on children. Firstly, there is evidence to support the idea that homework 2)_____nothing to improve educational outcomes. Countries such as Finland, where school children are not given homework, regularly top international educational league tables and outperform nations where setting homework is the norm. Secondly, many parents would agree that the school day is already 3)_____, and leaves their children too tired to do further study when they return home. 4)_____, it is recognised that play time is just as 5)_____as study time from the perspective of brain development.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 5.

(A) soon

(B) beneficial

(C) bad

(D) confidential

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**
Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**
Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**	

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) The additional amount earned on a loan or deposit

Interest is the extra amount, over and above the principal, that a lender earns on a loan or a depositor on a deposit; for the borrower it is the cost of borrowing.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Assam

Bihu, danced at the Bihu festivals and above all at Rongali (Bohag) Bihu in April, is the folk dance of Assam.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 1905

Curzon's government announced the partition of Bengal in July 1905, and it took effect on 16 October 1905. It was annulled in 1911.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 1, 2 and 4

The Prime Minister launched the scheme on 30 July 2022 (1); it aims at the operational efficiency and financial sustainability of the distribution companies (2) and plans about 25 crore smart prepaid meters for consumers (4). Statement 3 is wrong: as approved in 2021, and as it stood when the exam was held (September 2023), the scheme was to run for five years, FY 2021-22 to FY 2025-26.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Adolf Hitler

'Mein Kampf' ('My Struggle'), published in two volumes in 1925 and 1926, is Adolf Hitler's autobiography and political manifesto.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Australia

The Great Barrier Reef lies in the Coral Sea off the coast of Queensland, Australia.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Sonepur Mela

The Harihar Nath temple places it at Sonepur in Bihar, where the Gandak meets the Ganga: the Sonepur Mela, a livestock fair that begins on Kartik Purnima. The Pushkar fair, also held at Kartik Purnima, is in Rajasthan.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 6 states

The Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan, a 125-day public works campaign launched on 20 June 2020 for migrant workers who had returned home, covered 116 districts in six states: Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Jharkhand and Odisha.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Monthly channel

India Post's six mail channels, introduced for quicker delivery in large towns and cities, are the Rajdhani, Metro, Green, Business, Bulk Mail and Periodical channels. There is no 'Monthly' channel.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Sale of government-owned land

A non-debt capital receipt brings in money without creating a liability, as the sale of government assets such as land does. Loans are debt receipts, interest paid is expenditure, and taxes are revenue receipts.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Rabindranath Tagore

Rabindranath Tagore founded Visva-Bharati at Santiniketan in 1921; it became a central university in 1951.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 4

India won four golds at the Women's World Boxing Championships held in New Delhi in March 2023: Nitu Ghanghas (48 kg), Nikhat Zareen (50 kg), Lovlina Borgohain (75 kg) and Saweety Boora (81 kg).

Q.16 · Answer (B) Bharatanatyam

SSC's key gives Bharatanatyam, the classical dance Hema Malini learnt from childhood and is best known for. She later also studied other forms, Kuchipudi under Vempati Chinna Satyam among them, so those options are arguable, but Bharatanatyam is her principal form.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Governor
Under Article 207(1), a Money Bill may be introduced in a state legislature only on the recommendation of the Governor.

Q.18 · Answer (A) The Guide
R. K. Narayan wrote 'The Guide' (1958). 'Far From the Madding Crowd' is Thomas Hardy's, 'Godan' Premchand's and 'Untouchable' Mulk Raj Anand's.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Delhi
The Qutub Minar stands at Mehrauli in Delhi; Qutb-ud-din Aibak began it and Iltutmish completed it.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Yellowing of the skin and the whites of the eyes
Newborn jaundice comes from a build-up of bilirubin and shows as yellowing of the skin and the whites of the eyes. Cracks at the corners of the mouth point to a riboflavin deficiency, and swollen, bleeding gums to scurvy.

Q.21 · Answer (D) kg m/s
Linear momentum = mass × velocity, so its SI unit is kg m/s. (kg m/s² is the unit of force, the newton.)

Q.22 · Answer (B) Bengaluru
The 2023 SAFF Championship was played at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium in Bengaluru in June and July 2023; India beat Kuwait on penalties in the final on 4 July for their ninth title.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Weightlifting
Saikhom Mirabai Chanu, the Tokyo Olympics silver medallist in the women's 49 kg class, is a weightlifter. She won the BBC award for 2021 and again for 2022, the first to win it twice.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Fertile soil
Punjab's plains are made of fertile alluvial soil laid down by its rivers, which with irrigation make it one of India's leading wheat and rice producers.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 12
The Constitution had 12 Schedules in June 2023. It began with 8; the 9th was added in 1951, the 10th in 1985 and the 11th and 12th in 1992.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) Weaken
To 'diminish' is to make or become less: 'weaken'. To 'demote' or 'relegate' is to lower in rank, and to 'prevent' is to stop.

Q.3 · Answer (A) A
An action that began in the past and is still going on, with 'since', takes the present perfect continuous: 'We have been living here since the summer of last year.'

Q.4 · Answer (D) for
'For' goes with a period of time ('for two months'); 'since' goes with a point of time ('since May').

Q.5 · Answer (C) A very short distance
'A stone's throw' is a very short distance: the house is close to the school.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Accompanyment
The correct spelling is 'accompaniment': the 'y' of 'accompany' becomes 'i' before '-ment'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) added salt instead of sugar
Salt is 'added' to a dish: 'added salt instead of sugar'. 'Altered' (changed) does not fit, nor do 'anguished', 'amplified' or 'abridged'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) A life filled with excitement
To live 'in the fast lane' is to lead an exciting, hectic and often risky life; it is not about actual speed.

Q.9 · Answer (C) hardly
'Hardly' means scarcely; the adverb meaning 'with force' is 'hard': 'Sanjana rubbed her eyes hard.'

Q.10 · Answer (D) fight fire with fire
SSC's key gives 'fight fire with fire', to answer an opponent with the same kind of methods, which matches employers 'doing wrong to her'. 'Fight the good fight' (to keep striving for what is right) could also be read into the sentence, but it is about persevering in a just cause rather than hitting back at a wrongdoer; the other two idioms do not fit.

Q.11 · Answer (D) succed
The correct spelling is 'succeed', with a double 'e'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) can be lonely prospect
'Prospect' is a singular countable noun and needs an article: 'can be a lonely prospect'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) is cheaper than
A comparison with 'than' needs the comparative degree: 'is cheaper than the old one'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) shall
A confident guess about something already done takes 'must have' (or 'will have'): 'My relatives must have reached Amritsar by now.' 'Shall' is not used for such a guess about a third person.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Swarm
A group of bees is a 'swarm'; a 'gaggle' is of geese, a 'shoal' of fish and a 'pack' of wolves or dogs.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Refined
'Crude' means rough and unpolished; its opposite is 'refined'. 'Primitive' is close to it in meaning.

Q.17 · Answer (D) precedent
A 'precedent' is an earlier case or example that can be quoted in support of a claim, as in law.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Be expensive
To 'cost an arm and a leg' is to be very expensive.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Persist
To 'insist' is to keep demanding or maintaining something firmly, close to 'persist'. To 'resist' is to oppose, to 'assist' to help, and a 'heist' is a robbery.

Q.21 · Answer (D) argue
After the modal 'might' comes the bare infinitive: 'people might argue'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) does
'Homework' is an uncountable, singular subject and the sentence states a general fact, so the simple present: 'homework does nothing to improve educational outcomes'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) long enough
The parents' point is that the school day already takes up enough time and leaves children tired: 'already long enough'. 'Big enough' does not describe a length of time, and 'not enough' contradicts the reason.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Finally
After 'Firstly' and 'Secondly', 'Finally' introduces the last reason.

Q.25 · Answer (B) beneficial
Play time is 'just as beneficial as' study time for brain development, which supports the case against homework; 'bad' would contradict it.

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